



— FREE FILL-IN TEMPLATE

Restaurant Business Plan

A working plan you fill in yourself, section by section: the concept, the numbers, the team and the launch. Useful for your bank, your investors and yourself.

Restaurant name

Owner(s)

Date

How to use this template

Work through it in order and answer every prompt in your own words. Leave a section blank if you don't know the answer yet: that blank is your to-do list. Fill in the executive summary **last**, once everything else is written.

SECTION 1

Executive summary

In two or three sentences: what are you opening, where, and for whom?

What makes it different from the places already nearby?

How much money do you need, and what is it for?

What does success look like at the end of year one?

SECTION 2

Concept and menu

Service style

- ☐ Full service
- ☐ Quick service / counter
- ☐ Bar or taproom
- ☐ Café or bakery
- ☐ Food truck
- ☐ Other: _____

Ways guests can order

- ☐ Dine-in
- ☐ Takeout
- ☐ Online ordering
- ☐ Delivery apps
- ☐ Catering
- ☐ Other: _____

Describe the food, the room and the feel in a few sentences.

Your five signature items, and roughly what each will sell for.

SECTION 3

Guests, location and competition

Who are your regulars going to be? (Age, neighborhood, why they come, how often)

Location, and why it works: foot traffic, parking, visibility, nearby businesses.

What will you charge on an average check, and how does that compare with nearby places?

NEARBY COMPETITOR

WHAT THEY DO WELL

WHERE YOU'LL BEAT THEM

SECTION 4

Startup costs

Get real quotes wherever you can, and write down who each number came from.

ITEM	NOTES / QUOTE FROM	COST
Build-out and renovation		\$
Kitchen equipment		\$
Furniture, fixtures and décor		\$
POS system and card payment hardware		\$
Smallwares (plates, pans, utensils)		\$
Opening food and beverage inventory		\$
Licenses and permits		\$
Rent and utility deposits		\$
Insurance (first payment)		\$
Signage and launch marketing		\$
Hiring and training before opening		\$
Working capital (cash to cover the first months)		\$
Other		\$
Total startup cost		\$

EPAY POS note: Qualifying merchants can get EPAY hardware placed at no upfront cost. It's not a lease and not equipment financing. Ask whether your restaurant qualifies before budgeting for POS hardware.

SECTION 5

Monthly operating budget

Plan a typical month once you're up and running.

LINE	NOTES	PER MONTH
Sales	Covers per day × average check × days open	\$
Food and beverage cost		\$
Labor (wages and payroll taxes)		\$
Rent and occupancy		\$
Utilities		\$
Card processing fees		\$
POS software and subscriptions		\$
Insurance		\$
Marketing		\$
Repairs and maintenance		\$
Supplies (paper, cleaning, to-go)		\$
Loan payments		\$
Other		\$
Total monthly costs		\$
Profit (sales – total costs)		\$

Your break-even point

Fixed costs stay the same whatever you sell (rent, insurance, salaried staff). Variable costs rise with sales (food, hourly labor, processing). Write the variable costs as a share of sales, then:

$$\text{Break-even sales per month} = \text{fixed costs} \div (1 - \text{variable costs as a \% of sales})$$

Fixed costs per month

Variable costs as % of sales

Break-even sales per month

SECTION 6

Team

ROLE	HOW MANY	FULL / PART TIME	PAY RATE	WHO (IF KNOWN)
General manager				
Kitchen lead / chef				
Line cooks				
Servers / counter staff				
Bartenders				
Dishwashers / support				

How will tips be handled (pooled, shared or kept), and who approves adjustments?

SECTION 7

Operations

Hours _____ Seats _____

Main suppliers (food, beverage, paper goods)

What your POS must handle on day one

- ☐ Table and floor management, split checks, course firing
- ☐ Kitchen display or printed kitchen tickets
- ☐ Tips, tip pooling and adjustments after close
- ☐ Online ordering and delivery apps in one queue
- ☐ Employee clock-in and labor reports
- ☐ Daily sales reports you'll actually read

SECTION 8

Marketing

How will people first hear about you?

What will bring them back a second and third time?

SECTION 9

Launch checklist

60–90 days out

- ☐ Lease signed, build-out scheduled
- ☐ Licenses and permits applied for
- ☐ Equipment and POS ordered
- ☐ Suppliers set up
- ☐ Payment processing account approved

30 days out

- ☐ Staff hired, training dates set
- ☐ Menu finalized and priced
- ☐ Menu built into the POS
- ☐ Social pages and Google listing live

Opening week

- ☐ Health inspection passed
- ☐ POS and card terminals tested with real sales
- ☐ Friends-and-family soft opening
- ☐ End-of-day closeout practiced
- ☐ Opening announcement sent

Opening with EPAY POS?

Our team builds your menu into the system before install day, then handles setup and training. Book a demo with your actual menu:
epaypos.net/book-a-demo · 947-228-7226 ext. 3